

# Igor B. Martins

Researcher in Economic History, Lund University



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Malmö, Sweden

## Academic Experience

2024–

### Researcher

Lund University Sweden

2022–2023

### Postdoctoral Research Associate

University of Cambridge United Kingdom

2020–2023

### Postdoctoral Fellow

Lund University Sweden

2017–2018

### Visiting Researcher

Stellenbosch University South Africa

## Education

2016–2020

### Ph.D., Economic History

Lund University Sweden

2014–2016

### M.Sc., Economic History

Lund University Sweden

2008–2011

### B.Sc., Economics

Fundação Getulio Vargas Brazil

## Published works

- **Martins, I.** (forthcoming). Living Standards in Ghana, 1955–2005, in G. Austin, A. Britwum, L. Doumbia, A. Eckert, & N.Y. Spong (eds), *Labour and Work in Ghana Since Independence*, London: Bloomsbury Academic.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. (forthcoming). Från arbetskraft till kapital: Slaveriets ekonomiska logik i globalt perspektiv, *Statsvetenskaplig tidskrift*.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Capital and Coercion: Slavery after the 1807 import ban in the Cape Colony, *European Review of Economic History*, heag012.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. (2025). Theoretical Foundations of the Economics of Slavery: Enslaved people as capital investments in the Atlantic world, *Journal of Global History*, vol. 21, no. 1, pp.22–40.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). Is the Business of Conquest the Conquest of Business?, *The Case Centre*, 225-0045-1.

- Cilliers, J., Mariotti, M., & **Martins, I.** (2024). Fertility Responses to Short-Term Economic Stress: Price volatility and wealth shocks in a pre-transitional settler colony, *Explorations in Economic History*, 101620.
- Smythe, A., **Martins, I.**, & Andersson, M. (2024). Inequality, Poverty, and Economic Shrinking: How can developing countries build greater resilience for more sustainable development patterns?, *International Journal of Development Issues*, vol. 23, no. 1, pp.40–81.
- **Martins, I.**, & Schwaag Serger, S. (2023). An Age of Disentangled Research?, *Issues in Science and Technology*, vol. 40, no. 1, pp.38–43.
- **Martins, I.**, & Schwaag Serger, S. (2023). *Shifting Patterns in International Research Cooperation*, Stockholm: STINT.
- Axelsson, T., & **Martins, I.** (2023). Resilience to Shrinking as a Catch-up Strategy: A comparison of Brazil and Indonesia, 1964–2019, *Studies in Comparative International Development*, vol. 59, no. 3, pp.491–516.
- **Martins, I.**, Cilliers, J., & Fourie, J. (2022). Legacies of Loss: The health outcomes of slaveholder compensation in the British Cape Colony, *Explorations in Economic History*, 101506.
- **Martins, I.** (2020). Collateral Effect: Slavery and wealth in the Cape Colony, PhD thesis, Department of Economic History, Lund University.
- Palacio, A., & **Martins, I.** (2019). What Caused Poverty Reduction in Brazil During the 2000s: Sectoral growth or public expenditures, *OASIS. Observatorio de Analisis de los Sistemas Internacionales*, vol. 32, pp.1–25.
- Palacio, A., & **Martins, I.** (2018). Poverty and Democracy: The Brazilian experience, in D. Rauhut & N. Hatti (eds), *Poverty, Politics and the Poverty of Politics*, New Delhi: B.R. Publishing Corporation, pp.193–210.

## Works under review

- **Martins, I.** (2026). Art, Craft, and the Case for Artisanal Doctoral Supervision in the Humanities, *Studies in Higher Education*. Revise & Resubmit.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Retrieval-Restricted Reasoning: A Proof of Concept for Adapting Language Models to Economic History, *Historical Methods: A Journal of Quantitative and Interdisciplinary History*. Revise & Resubmit.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Slave Emancipation and Agricultural Output in the Cape Colony, *Cliometrica*. Submitted.
- Makuei, J., & **Martins, I.** (2026). Democracy and Rural Inequality in Kenya, 1997–2010, *African Affairs*. Submitted.
- **Martins, I.**, Grab, S., & Green, E. (2026). Asset ownership turns climate exposure into inequality, *Nature Communications*. Revise & Resubmit.

## Work in progress

- **Martins, I.**, Schoots, J., & Green, E. Held by the Elite: Monopoly Rights and Dynastic Persistence at the Cape Colony, 1680–1794.
- Smythe, A., & **Martins, I.** Resilience and Growth Theory: A novel conceptualisation of convergence.
- Cilliers, J., & **Martins, I.** Malthus at the Cape: Wealth, status, and mortality in a pre-industrial settler society.
- Cilliers, J., & **Martins, I.** Forebearers: The forgotten women of the Cape Colony.
- **Martins, I.**, & Green, E. What Are Institutions Made Of? A social contract approach.
- **Martins, I.**, Aboagye, P., & Austin, G. The Ghanaian Divergence: Prices, incomes and living standards after independence.

## External funding

2027–2029

### Handelsbanken Research Foundations

Flying Blind: Tsetse Ecology, Colonial Response and Long-Run Health in Southeast Africa (P26-0357) Project researcher. Engaged at 30% for three years.  
SEK 1,500,000 ( $\approx$  EUR 138,500 / USD 163,000)

2024–2027

### Vetenskapsrådet

Causes and Consequences of Long-Term Inequality: Africa's Levels and Trends (2023-00809\_VR) Project researcher. Engaged at 20% for two years.  
SEK 6,737,000 ( $\approx$  EUR 623,623 / USD 735,688)

2022–2026

### Handelsbanken Research Foundations

Resilience to Economic Shrinking: The Role of Autonomous Financial Systems (P21-0044) Project researcher. Engaged at approx. 30% for two years.  
SEK 1,725,000 ( $\approx$  EUR 150,000 / USD 164,000)

2022–2025

### Arts and Humanities Research Council (UK)

Where have all the Workers Gone? Labour and Work in Ghana, 1951–2010 (AH/W010852/1) Postdoctoral Research Associate. Engaged at 100% for one year.  
SEK 3,332,000 ( $\approx$  EUR 308,438 / GBP 268,859)

2021–2026

### Riksbankens Jubileumsfond

The establishment, growth and legacy of a settler colony: Quantitative panel studies of the political economy of the Cape Colony (M20-0041) Project researcher. Engaged at 40% for four years (2021–2024) and 20% for two years (2025–2026).  
SEK 29,000,000 ( $\approx$  EUR 2,520,000 / USD 2,760,000)

2017–2018

### Erasmus Mundus Action 2 Programme (INSPIRE)

Scholarship Stellenbosch University, South Africa  
Supported research training on the economic history of the Cape Colony.  
SEK 157,000

*Pending PI applications (submitted 2025–2026)*

2026–

**Vetenskapsrådet (VR)**

TIES (Theory of Institutions as Embedded Social Contracts) Principal Investigator  
SEK 6,632,892

## Teaching experience

2025–

**Development in a Historical Perspective - Economic, Social and Political Transformation**

Lund University Course convener

2023–2026

**Growth, Stagnation, and Inequality in Africa**

Lund University Course convener

2019–2026

**The Art of Writing and Reporting**

Lund University Course convener

2019–

**Colonialism and Economic Change in Africa, Asia and Latin America**

Lund University Lecturer

2019–2026

**Field Work/Internship and Research Overview**

Lund University Course convener

## Pedagogical qualifications

2026–

**Teaching portfolio**

The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2025

**Course design in higher education**

The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2024

**Doctoral supervision**

The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2022

**Teaching and learning in higher education II**

The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2021

**Teaching and learning in higher education I**

The Joint Faculties of Humanities and Theology Lund University, Sweden

2020

**How to teach with cases**

Lund University School of Economics and Management Lund University, Sweden

2019

**How to write cases**

Lund University School of Economics and Management Lund University, Sweden

## Supervision

2023–2026

### Doctoral

Benjamin Chatterton, PhD in Economic History Lund University

Co-supervisor

Expected completion November 2026

2021–

### Master's

11 theses in Economic History Lund University

2019–

### Bachelor's

7 theses in Economic History Lund University

## Awards

2020

### Teacher of the Year

Lund University School of Economics and Management

## Media Outreach

- **Martins, I.** (2026). Assessing students' academic writing when AI can produce a first draft, *Times Higher Education*.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Portuguese Sources and the Shape of an Angolan Social Table, *African Long-Term Inequality Trends (AFLIT)*.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Capital and Coercion: Why Slavery Persisted after Britain Banned the Trade, *European Historical Economics Society*.
- **Martins, I.** (2026). Theoretical Foundations of the Economics of Slavery: Enslaved people as capital investments in the Atlantic world, *Frontiers in African Economic History Blog*.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). Devo, não nego, pago com o meu escravo - Como pessoas escravizadas viravam garantia de crédito, *The Conversation Brasil*.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). What Is Economic History?, *Tell Me About* [podcast].
- **Martins, I.** (2025). Students Learn Best When They're Not Handed a Map: 4 steps to structure discomfort in your case classroom, *Inspiring Minds*.
- **Martins, I.** (2025). The Pressure to Quantify Research Is Erasing Conceptual Depth, *LSE Impact Blog*.
- Kim, H., Schwaag Serger, S., Mobrand, E., & **Martins, I.** (2024). International Science Is Having a Messy Breakup, *Research Professional News*.
- **Martins, I.** (2023). Does a Negative Wealth Shock Affect Your Health? Evidence from an episode of 'Expropriation with Partial Compensation' in nineteenth-century South Africa, *Our Long Walk: Reflections on South Africa, from an Economic History Perspective*.
- **Martins, I.** (2023). Legacies of Loss: The health outcomes of slaveholder compensation in the British Cape Colony, *Frontiers in African Economic History Blog*.

## Editorial and Review Experience

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|-------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026– | <b>Peer-reviewer</b><br>Studies in Higher Education                      |
| 2025  | <b>Peer-reviewer</b><br>International Journal of Development Issues      |
| 2025  | <b>Peer-reviewer</b><br>Asia-Pacific Economic History Review             |
| 2024  | <b>Peer-reviewer</b><br>Studies in Comparative International Development |
| 2023  | <b>Peer-reviewer</b><br>Technological Forecasting and Social Change      |

## Service

|           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025–2026 | <b>United Nations Development Programme</b><br>Consultant<br>Commissioned by the UNDP's Strategy, Policy and Capacities for Economic Management (SPACE) Unit of South Sudan as a consultant to the country's first Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) report.                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 2023–     | <b>Swedish Economic History Association</b><br>Auditor<br>The SEHA promotes the spread of knowledge about economic and social history, as well as historical and geographical research. The association organises lectures and conferences.                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 2017–     | <b>Laboratory for the Economics of Africa's Past</b><br>Stellenbosch University<br>Visiting Researcher<br>The Laboratory for the Economics of Africa's Past is dedicated to the quantitative study of African economic and social history.                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 2023–2025 | <b>World Economic History Congress 2025</b><br>Lund, Sweden<br>Conference Manager<br>Co-organised the 19th WEHC, a major international conference in economic history with over 1,200 participants. Contributed to programme coordination, hybrid participation logistics, volunteer management, statistical reporting, and post-conference analysis. Oversaw technical workflows, communication, and strategic structuring of the scientific and cultural programme. |
| 2023–2024 | <b>The Swedish Foundation for International Cooperation in Research and Higher Education (STINT)</b><br>Consultant<br>STINT supports internationalisation in Swedish higher education by funding initiatives led by researchers, educators, and academic leaders.                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

2022–2023

**Clare Hall** Affiliated Postdoctoral Member

Clare Hall is a constituent college of the University of Cambridge established to serve as an Institute of Advanced Studies.

2021–2023

**Swedish Economic History Association**

Treasurer

2019–2020

**Ekonomisk Doktorandrådet (EDR)**

Lund University

President

EDR functions as a platform for communication, driving the matters of doctoral students at LUSEM and ensuring the representation of doctoral students at faculty levels.

2018–2019

**Ekonomisk Doktorandrådet (EDR)**

Lund University

Vice-President

2018–2020

**The Economic History Society**

University of Glasgow

Student Ambassador

EHS Student Ambassadors facilitate communication between the Economic History Society and students interested in economic and/or social history.

## Professional memberships

Economic History Association, Economic History Society, Social Science History Association, African Economic History Network, Swedish Economic History Association

## Recent conferences, workshops and seminars

02/2026

**Trelleborgs Biblioteket**

Trelleborg, Sweden **Speaker**

How did colonial institutions shape African democracy and development?

07/2025

**World Economic History Congress**

Lund, Sweden **Organiser & Panellist**

The geography of development in Portuguese Africa: Lessons from Angola

12/2024

**African Studies Association**

Chicago, USA **Panellist**

Market Integration and the Development of Capitalism in Ghana, 1987–2005

12/2023

**Utbildningsdepartementet**

Stockholm, Sweden **Panellist**

Shifting patterns in international research collaboration

09/2023

**Seminarium om förändrade mönster för internationella forskningssamarbeten**

Stockholm, Sweden **Panellist**

Shifting patterns in international research collaboration

09/2023

**Swedish Economic History meeting**

Lund, Sweden **Organizer & Panellist**

Resilience and Growth Theory: A novel conceptualisation of convergence

03/2023

**African Economic History Seminar**Cambridge, United Kingdom **Panellist**

Raising capital to raise crops: Slave emancipation and agricultural output in the Cape Colony

**Selected earlier conferences (2017–2022)**

07/2022

**World Economic History Congress**Paris, France **Panellist**

07/2018

**World Economic History Congress**Boston, USA **Panellist**

10/2022

**African Economic History Network annual meeting**Tenerife, Spain **Panellist**

10/2018

**African Economic History Network annual meeting**Bologna, Italy **Panellist**

10/2017

**African Economic History Network annual meeting**Stellenbosch, South Africa **Panellist**

04/2018

**European Social Science History Conference**Belfast, UK **Panellist**

01/2019

**Allied Social Sciences Association**Atlanta, USA **Panellist**

10/2021

**Swedish Economic History meeting**Gothenburg, Sweden **Panellist**

10/2019

**Swedish Economic History meeting**Uppsala, Sweden **Panellist****Administrative reference****Prof. Mats Olsson**

Lund University, Sweden

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**Academic references****Prof. Erik Green**

Lund University, Sweden

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**Prof. Anne McCants**

MIT, USA

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**Prof. Gareth Austin**

University of Cambridge, UK

gma31@cam.ac.uk

**Prof. Jeanne Cilliers**

Linköping University, Sweden

jeanne.cilliers@liu.se

**Teaching references****Dr. Tobias Axelsson**

Lund University, Sweden

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**Assoc. Prof. Tobias Karlsson**

Lund University, Sweden

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